Debugging or monitoring network traffic

Imagine the following problem: your EC2 instance does not accept SSH traffic as you want it to, but you can't spot any misconfiguration in your firewall rules. The following two strategies are helpful:

- Use the VPC Reachability Analyzer to simulate the traffic and see if the tool finds the configuration problem. Learn more at http://mng.bz/wyqW.
- Enable VPC Flow Logs to get access to aggregated log messages containing rejected connections. Learn more at http://mng.bz/qoqE.

5.4.1 Controlling traffic to virtual machines with security groups

A security group acts as a firewall for virtual machines and other services. You will associate a security group with AWS resources, such as EC2 instances, to control traffic. It's common for EC2 instances to have more than one security group associated with them and for the same security group to be associated with multiple EC2 instances.

A security group consists of a set of rules. Each rule allows network traffic based on the following:

- Direction (inbound or outbound)
- IP protocol (TCP, UDP, ICMP)
- Port
- Source/destination based on IP address, IP address range, or security group (works only within AWS)